AI PRODUCT MANAGEMENT CASE STUDY · LIVE DEMO, LAUNCH CHECK PENDING · NOVEMBER 2026

AI Personal Stylist

A video stylist that jots notes as you talk, then builds looks you refine by voice or touch

For anyone dressing for an occasion on their phone. A working web app, built in three weeks by Sabine Joseph, an AI product manager directing Claude Code, with quality defined before it was measured.

97%
of notes within 2 seconds of their phrase (target 95%, in-sample)

96% / 83%
of note checks right, in-sample / blind set (target 90%; the blind set not met)

16 of 16
planted rule breaks caught by code before any look is shown

$1.15
of AI per 10-minute demo: 5 cents over the $1.10 target

The problem

Online shopping gives you a search box and a thousand results that don't go together. A good stylist listens, remembers, looks at what you own, and builds a whole outfit within your budget and rules. AI chat listens, then forgets your budget and shows you the heels you ruled out. The problem is my own: I shop for occasions on my phone.

What I built

- **My Styling Notes:** the stylist jots free-form notes while you talk; a tap confirms or removes one, a correction by voice rewrites it. Nothing is a rule until confirmed.
- **Looks around what you own:** a photo or the live camera names your item; three complete looks are built around it, your own pieces never in the totals.
- **One gate:** every look passes a preference check (rules in code, then a model's judgment) before it reaches the screen. Then keep, change, swap, undo, compare; save a look; a demo bag that cannot check out.
- **Degrade, never break; privacy and budget built in:** voice carries on when video can't; no recordings, photos deleted with the session, download or delete all; a daily allowance and monthly stops before every paid call.

Key decisions

- **A notebook, not a form:** notes in the stylist's own words, so the conversation feels heard; the price was a reader that must be fast and right mid-sentence.
- **The stylist only speaks and listens:** video and voice are swappable outside services; my server makes every decision and holds every key.
- **Accuracy first, then speed, then cost:** four models measured on the same sentences before any screen was built; the most accurate one, Opus, was too slow for live notes.
- **Specs before code:** product, design and tech specs and a phased plan, kept current; a phone check and a code review closed every phase.

My role

I'm a product manager, not a developer. I wrote the specs from a PRD, set every target before any result, made every product decision and approved each plan before code changed. Claude Code wrote the code: 73 pull requests from 18 to 31 October, each tested before it merged.

How I measured quality

Targets set on 17 to 21 October 2026, before any result, and never moved.

Measure	Target	Result
Notes within 2 s / right, 63 in-sample sentences	95% / 90%	97% / 96%
Notes within 2 s / right, 15 blind sentences	95% / 90%	85% / 83%, not met
Rule breaks caught, 37 looks	All	16 of 16
Judged looks right	90%	21 of 21
Photo details right, 24 photos	85%	93%
Interruption by button	0.5 s	0.7 s, not met
AI cost per demo	$1.10	$1.15, not met
Phone speed (Lighthouse)	90	98

What I learned

- Measuring before building changed the model choice; a blind set then showed how much my own cases flattered the reader.
- Cost became a product problem: one session's judgments hit the daily allowance in my own check; the limit, plain limit messages and a free Undo followed.
- The automatic accessibility scanner passed, but measuring by hand found five layout problems at 200% text and 44 px, and one conflict in my own spec.

> **Limits:** most answers were mine, so the scores are in-sample; the blind set (15 new sentences, written apart from the reader) scored 83% right and 85% in time: the honest estimate for new sentences. One tester, one iPhone; no stranger yet. Catalog photos, not phone photos. Taste isn't measured, only rules. No purchases yet.

What's next

- A stranger's first session, timed against a 3-minute first look.
- Fix the blind set's misses; add captions or typing.
- A retailer-link pilot: looks saved, kept orders, returns.

In the repository: README, docs/evaluation.md, Project Memory (specs and plan), the architecture diagram, checks. Live at ai-personal-stylist-inky.vercel.app. Page 2: the business model.

Sabine Joseph, AI product manager, directing Claude Code as a non-developer. Code and documents: github.com/sabinejoseph8/ai-personal-stylist.

Business model

Affiliate commission from high-end retailers, assumed at 5% of what shoppers keep

v1 has no links: the products are a sample catalog and nothing is for sale. This page is the plan for after v1, and the test of whether a session pays for itself.

5%
assumed commission on what the shopper keeps, through the retailer's affiliate program

$32
earned on FWRD's average order, about $640 in 2025 before returns

1 in 7 or 8
video sessions must end in a kept order to pay for themselves

1 in 19 to 34
voice sessions must end in a kept order to pay for themselves

How it would earn

Each piece in a look would link to the retailer's own site through its affiliate program, and the app would earn a commission on what the shopper keeps, assumed at 5%. My hypothesis is that a video stylist's more personal styling suits higher-ticket items, so the target is a high-end retailer such as FWRD. The shopper pays the retailer's price; the retailer handles checkout, delivery and returns.

Does a session pay for itself?

A 10-minute session costs about $0.95 to $1.65 with the voice stylist and $3.95 to $4.65 with the video stylist: $0.45 to $1.15 of Claude, plus OpenAI voice at $0.05 a minute or Tavus video at $0.35 a minute. Hosting isn't counted. FWRD's average order was about $640 in 2025, before returns (Revolve Group's 2025 annual report): about $32 at 5%.

The riskiest assumption

That one in 7 or 8 video sessions ends in a kept order: far above usual online shopping conversion, and returned orders earn nothing. A $300 basket would need one in 3 or 4, which is why the target is high end. That rate is the first thing to measure with real shoppers.

Ready for links

Every product already has an empty purchase link and a "can be bought" flag, so a retailer's feed is a new connector, not a redesign.

Break-even per 10-minute session, at 5%

A 10-minute session	Cost to run	Kept spend to break even	In average FWRD orders ($32 each)
Voice stylist	$0.95 to $1.65	$19 to $33	One in every 19 to 34 sessions
Video stylist	$3.95 to $4.65	$79 to $93	One in every 7 or 8 sessions

Sources: the Claude cost per session was measured in the app's own sessions (docs/evaluation.md); FWRD's average order is from Revolve Group's 2025 annual report.

Not yet tested: v1 has no links, so no commission has been earned and no kept-order rate measured.